Jenson Nelson

Senior Designer
Trend-Driven Visual Storyteller
Nike-Ready

Professional Summary

As a Senior Designer with 13 years in the industry and an LA sensibility, I specialize in translating culture and trend into color-rich, emotionally intelligent design across product, graphics, and brand storytelling.

Nike-Ready Skills

- **Cross-Disciplinary *Athlete:**
  Proven ability to concept and iterate with product designers, developers, and marketers in high-speed, high-stakes environments.
- **Trend-Driven & Culturally Tuned:**
  My design voice pulls from contemporary art, sport, streetwear, and global culture. I stay plugged in and bring fresh insight to every project.
- **Reliable Narrator:**
  Strategically build graphic systems that ladder up to holistic looks across footwear, apparel, and accessories. Always intentional. Always wearable.
- **Color-First Thinking:**
  Skilled in color theory, palette curation, material texture, and finish—my work brings hues to life with emotional resonance.
- **Industry-Leading Graphics:**
  From print and pattern to type and layout, I build graphics that stick. Work that's trend-right, consumer-smart, and unapologetically bold.
- **Toolbox Depth:**
  Adobe Creative Suite expert. Comfortable with 3D exploration and AI-assisted design tools. Equal parts analog and digital thinker.

Work Experience

Creative Associate: *Good Fight Political | Remote, OR | March 2023 – January 2025*

- Built campaign brand systems (logos, social graphics, web ads) rooted in cultural relevance and emotional clarity—driving a 40% lift in engagement.
- Led A/B-tested digital ad campaigns across paid social and display—boosting sign-ups and click-through rates by 40%.
- Streamlined production pipelines by optimizing CMS workflows and external vendor reviews, ensuring brand consistency across fast-paced deliverables.

Freelance Designer (Brand, Product & Presentation): *Self-Employed | Portland, OR | March 2020 – February 2023*

- Owned end-to-end digital projects—translating complex ideas into clear, visually dynamic decks, marketing tools, and webinar graphics for global teams.

- Partnered with agencies and developers to build scalable asset libraries that maintained fidelity to evolving brand guidelines under tight deadlines.
- Applied trend research and storytelling to brand touchpoints across web, apparel, and packaging—designing from strategy through delivery.

Senior Graphic & Product Designer: *99 Cents Only Stores | Commerce, CA | September 2017 – bruary 2020*

- Designed products, packaging and in-store campaigns that generated $19.83M in sales in 2019, setting a 21% year-over-year sales growth forecast.
- Created trend-driven seasonal assets that fused product storytelling with high-volume retail execution.
- Led communication with international vendors, managing timelines and specs to cut production turnaround by 25% without sacrificing quality.

Art Director & Graphic Designer: *1933 Group | Los Angeles, CA | December 2014 – July 2016*

- Concepted and produced venue branding, merch, and social assets across a portfolio of eight notable LA-based hospitality venues.
- Designed merchandise with story-driven visuals unique to each space, supporting brand extension and B2B licensing partnerships.

Creative Director & Graphic Designer: *Handmade Mobile Entertainment | Santa Monica, CA | December 2012 – July 2014*

- Directed creative strategy and campaign execution for mobile entertainment platforms, integrating celebrity brand assets (Soulja Boy, Trey Songz, Toni Braxton) into cohesive visuals.
- Designed in-app graphics, promotional banners, and social media assets, enhancing product visibility and user acquisition.
- Produced high-performing digital campaigns while managing end-to-end asset production to support aggressive product rollout schedules.

Education

California State University, Long Beach | 2005-2007
Multi-/Interdisciplinary Studies, General

Chasing My Dream

I've been obsessed with design since childhood—sketching outfits with matching shoes in margins during class, and sewing my own clothes in high school. Raised in Nikes thanks to my dad's endorsement deal as Eddie Money's lead guitarist, I lived the brand long before I understood branding. As a varsity athlete at 15, joining Nike wasn't just a goal; it felt like destiny. Check out my dad rocking Nikes at the US Festival in front of 450,000 people—proof that this brand runs in my blood.

In November 2019, I was traveling in New Zealand, when a coworker accidentally cc'd me on an email I wasn't supposed to see until I got home: my entire LA department was being let go. I didn't panic—my first thought: "Sell your stuff, pack up, chase your dream job at Nike in Portland. If not now, when?"

Moving was easy, being the first in my family to leave Los Angeles was tough. I arrived in Portland on Friday the 13th of March 2020. By Monday, pandemic-induced panic-buying and lockdown had begun. Grabbing my seat at Nike felt like a sliding door situation, and it closed on a few of my fingers. The movers lost my stuff for two months—but I thrived: art supplies from Mom, a piano, weird songs, painting, reading—kinda like a rich monk in overalls. But all I could think was, "Just a few more months 'til Nike."

Since then, I've done fun, meaningful work, but I'm craving a community and culture to champion. I'm ready to join a team that elevates greatness—and I think Nike is finally ready for me. I won't settle. This is my dream job, and I'm all in.

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